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GENERATING ACTION RECOMMENDATIONS BASED ON ATTRIBUTES ASSOCIATED WITH INCIDENTS USED FOR INCIDENT RESPONSE

Abstract

Described herein are systems and methods for enhancing an interface for an information technology (IT) environment. In one implementation, an incident service causes display of a first version of a course of action and obtains input indicative of a request for a new action in the course of action. The incident service further determines suggested actions based at least one the input and causes display of the suggested actions. Once displayed, the incident service obtains input indicative of a selection of at least one action from the suggested actions, and causes display input indicative of a selection of at least one action from the suggested actions.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 18/536,794, filed Dec. 12, 2023, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 17/327,098, filed May 21, 2021, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,863,583, which is a continuation of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/051,247, filed Jul. 31, 2018, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,038,915, the entire contents of which are hereby incorporated by reference as if fully set forth herein. The applicant(s) hereby rescind any disclaimer of claim scope in the parent application(s) or the prosecution history thereof and advise the USPTO that the claims in this application may be broader than any claim in the parent application(s).

TECHNICAL BACKGROUND

[0002] An increasing number of threats exist in the modern computerized society. These threats may include viruses or other malware that attack a local computer of an end user, or sophisticated cyber-attacks to gather data from or otherwise infiltrate a complex information technology (IT) environment. Such IT environments include real and virtual computing devices executing various applications used to provide a variety of services, such as data routing and storage, cloud processing, web sites and services, amongst other possible services. To protect applications and services, various antivirus, encryption, and firewall tools may be used across an array of computing devices and operating systems, such as Linux® and Microsoft Windows®.

[0003] IT environments may employ a variety of computing components with different hardware and software configurations to provide the desired operation. These computing components may include end user computing devices, host computing devices, virtual machines, switches, routers, and the like. However, as more computing components are added to an IT environment, those same components become available as targets of potential security threats or incidents. The increasing number computing components in combination with limited administrative personnel and resources can make it difficult to manage the investigation and remediation of potential threats. Even with ample administrators or analyst users, it can be cumbersome to coordinate the investigation and remediation efforts.

Overview

[0004] Described herein are improvements for generating courses of action for an information technology (IT) environment. In one implementation, a method includes causing display of a first version of a course of action, the first version of the course of action comprising one or more actions, and obtaining input indicative of a request for a new action in the course of action. The method further includes determining suggested actions based at least on the input and causing display of the suggested actions. The method also provides obtaining input indicative of a selection of at least one action from the suggested actions and causing display of a second version of the course of action, wherein the second version of the course of action comprises the one or more actions and the at least one selected action.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0005] FIGS. **1A** and **1B** illustrate an interface for defining a course of action according to an implementation.

[0006] FIG. **2** illustrates an information technology (IT) environment according to an implementation.

[0007] FIG. **3** illustrates an operation of an incident service according to an implementation.

[0008] FIG. **4** illustrates a timing diagram for determining and maintaining course of action trends according to an implementation.

[0009] FIG. **5** illustrates an operational scenario of providing suggested actions according to an implementation.

[0010] FIGS. **6A-6B** illustrate an interface for defining a course of action according to an implementation.

[0011] FIG. **7** illustrates an interface indicative of frequently used paths in a course of action according to an implementation.

[0012] FIG. **8** illustrates an incident service computing system according to an implementation.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0013] FIGS. **1A** and **1B** illustrate an interface for defining a course of action according to an implementation. FIG. **1A** includes an example course of action **100** that includes start action **121**, geolocate internet protocol (IP) action **122**, file reputation action **123**, and end action **127**. FIG. **1A** further includes suggested actions **140** with actions **130-135** and selector **150**.

[0014] In FIG. **1A**, an incident service of an information technology (IT) environment may provide a platform that permits analysts associated with the environment to generate and implement courses of action to respond to incidents in the environment. These incidents may include or be associated with viruses, malware, spyware, denial of service attacks, phishing attacks, server crashes, device failures, power outages, or other similar incidents. The course of actions defined by the analysts may comprise one or more actions, wherein the actions may be used to mitigate, monitor, remove, or provide any other similar operations to remediate, correct, or otherwise respond to the incident.

[0015] As depicted in FIG. **1A**, course of action **100** is depicted as a flow diagram capable of linking or connecting various actions to respond to an incident. In various examples, a course of action can comprise an operational flow of actions to respond to the incident. In the particular example depicted in FIG. **1A**, start action **121** is connected to both geolocate IP action **122** and file reputation action **123**, wherein an analyst may have manually selected the two actions for responding to a particular type of incident based on professional experience or personal knowledge. In various implementations, actions can be added to the course of action **100**. As actions are added to course of action **100**, embodiments of the present disclosure can generate suggested action **140** to be added to the operational flow or process of the course of action **100**. In some implementations, an analyst may use selector **150**, or other graphical user interface (GUI) control element, to indicate a request to link or add an action, in this example geolocate IP action **122**, to another action to the flow of actions defined in course of action **100**. When selector **150** is selected, a new link **104** and suggested actions **140** may be generated based various factors. For example, suggested actions **140** may be determined based on the type of action corresponding to the preceding action (e.g. geolocate IP), may be determined based on the other actions or sequences of actions that are already defined in course of action **100**, or may be determined based on any other information from or associated with course of action **100** or the associated incident or incident type.

[0016] In some implementations, in addition to or in place of the information derived from the request, the incident service may also generate suggested actions **140** based on trends identified from previously defined courses of actions. Such courses of actions may be generated by the same

analyst, by other analysts of the same IT environment, by analysts in other IT environments, or some other similar trend. The trends may be determined based on the frequency that actions are implemented in a course of action, the frequency that actions are sequenced in a particular order, or some other similar trend. Suggested actions **140** may include actions to determine additional supplemental information for the incident, implement a configuration modification in at least one component of the IT environment, compare previously obtained information for the incident against criteria or thresholds, decision or split actions, ending the course of action, or providing any other similar type of action in the course of action.

[0017] Turning to FIG. **1B**, once the analyst selects an action from actions **130-135**, a new action may appear, represented as a box in the flow diagram, in course of action **100**. Here, decision action **124** is generated and is used as a decision action to split the path in the course of action **100**. In this particular example, decision action **124** and function **132** determines whether the location information derived from geolocate IP action **122** corresponds to a particular location, and if the location information does correspond to the particular location then course of action **100** follows path **107**. When the location information does not correspond to the particular location, then decision action **124** causes course of action **100** to follow path **108**. Once the new action is added to course of action **100**, the analyst generating the course of action may again select new actions to link to the any other action in the course of action **100**. Thus, when the analyst selects an option to add an action to path **108**, the analyst may be provided with suggested actions **170** and actions **160-165**, wherein actions **160-165** may comprise different actions than those provided in suggested actions **140** of FIG. **1A**, and wherein suggested actions **170** may be identified in a similar manner to that of suggested actions **140**.

[0018] FIG. **2** illustrates an IT environment **200** according to an implementation. IT environment **200** includes analyst systems **210-214**, analysts **260-263**, incident service **220**, network **230**, and response database **250**. Network **230** further includes components **240-243** wherein components **240-243** may comprise physical computing systems, virtual computing systems, routers, switches, firewalls, or some other similar types of computing elements, including combinations thereof. Incident service **220** further provides operation **300** described in FIG. **3**.

[0019] In operation, incident service **220** provides a platform that permits analysts **260-264** to respond to incidents that occur in the IT environment. To respond to the incidents, incident service **220** may manage courses of action that each include one or more actions to respond to various incident types. For example, a power outage may correspond to a first course of action, while a second course of action may correspond to an unknown process executing on a component of network **230**. In generating the courses of action, incident service **220** may provide or generate an interface that permits analysts via analyst systems **210-214** to indicate a flow diagram of actions desired to respond to a particular incident. For example, a course of action may be generated by analyst **264** that, when an unknown communication is identified for a component of network **130**, incident service should determine a geolocation of the source of the communication and configure a firewall based on whether communication originated from a particular geolocation. Thus, a first action in the course of action may determine the geolocation of the communication, a second action may determine whether the location meets criteria, and a third action may configure a firewall when the location meets the criteria.

[0020] Here, to assist analysts **260-264** in generating the courses of action, incident service **220** may provide suggestions to an analyst indicating actions that could follow another action in the course of action. These suggestions may be based on the action that supersedes the new action, may be based on the action that follows the new action, may be based on other actions implemented in the course of action, may be based on trends from other courses of action of IT environment **100**, may be based on trends from other courses of action in other IT environments, or may be based on any other similar factor. In at least one implementation, incident service **220** may access response database **250**, wherein response database **250** may store information related to recommending

actions for analysts **260-264** during development of a particular course of action. The information may include sequencing information for which actions follow other actions, and may comprise explicit rules (e.g. rule A should always be suggested to follow rule B), may comprise information about other courses of action implemented in the environment, or may comprise information about other courses of action implemented

[0021] FIG. 3 illustrates an operation **300** of an incident service according to an implementation. The functions of operation **300** are described parenthetically in the paragraphs that follow with reference to systems and elements of IT environment **200** of FIG. 3, as well as course of action **100** of FIGS. 1A-1B.

[0022] As depicted, operation **300** includes causing (**301**) display of a first version of a course of action, wherein the course of action comprises one or more actions. This first version of the course of action may comprise a flow, depicted as a graph, chart, diagram, text or combination thereof, that provides sequencing information for the one or more actions in the course of action. Referring to an example from IT environment **200**, analyst **264** may make, to the incident service **220** using a corresponding analyst system **214**, a request to implement a new course of action and indicate one or more actions to be defined as part of the course of action. In one example embodiment, the analyst may define a type of incident for which the course of action is to be used, and indicate an initial action to be performed as part of the course of action. Once the request or requests for the course of action are identified from analyst **264**, incident service **220** may cause display of the first version of the course of action.

[0023] After causing display of the first version of the course of action, operation **300** obtains (**302**) input indicative of a request for a new action in the course of action. In at least one implementation, the input may comprise a request to add a subsequent action to the flow diagram following a preexisting action. As an example, a first action may determine a geolocation associated with an IP address for an incident, and the user may desire to perform a subsequent action that uses the information from the geolocation action. The input may be provided via a mouse, a touch display, or some other similar interface, and may be provided via the selection of an icon, button, an action block in the course of action, or some other similar object in the course of action interface.

Referring to an example in course of action **100** of FIG. 1A, the user selects an icon as part of geolocate IP action **122** to trigger the request of a new action for the course of action.

[0024] After obtaining the input, operation **300** determines (**303**) suggested actions based at least in part on the input and causes (**304**) display of the suggested actions. In some implementations, incident service **220** may identify that the input indicates a request to add a subsequent action to an action previously added to the course of action. This request may be identified based on the icon or object selected by the analyst, may be determined based on information provided in the request from the analyst, or may be based in any other information. Referring to the example in course of action **100** of FIG. 1A, an analyst may select an icon on the edge of an action (geolocate IP action **122**) in the flow diagram of course of action **100** to request a new action in the course of action. From the selection, the incident service may determine which preexisting action in the course of action will flow or continue to the new action and determine action suggestions based at least on the preexisting action. For example, if a request is for a new action in a course of action following a file reputation determination action, then the action suggestions may be determined based on the information obtained from the file reputation determination action. In particular, actions suggestions may be determined based on actions that can use the file reputation information (e.g. block IP actions based on the reputation of the file), and may further be determined based on the format of the data returned as part of the file reputation determination. For example, actions may be identified based on actions that can use the format of the score or value returned as part of the file reputation determination action. In some instances, the suggested actions may be determined based on attributes or parameters that were identified from the incident (e.g. domain names, IP addresses, and the like), wherein actions that perform operations using the attributes or parameters may be

prioritized or promoted over other types of actions. Additionally, incident service **220** may consider the parameters that are returned from other actions in promoting new actions for the course of action. Referring to the example of the file reputation action, actions capable of using the returned parameter from the file reputation action may be promoted over other types of actions.

[0025] In other implementations, in addition to or in place of using information about the previous actions, incident service **220** may further consider any other actions that are currently implemented in the course of action, trends from other courses of action developed for the IT environment, trends from other courses of actions in other IT environments, or some other similar factor. As an example, when a request is generated to add a new action to follow an existing action, incident service **220** may determine trends in actions that follow the existing action from other courses of action for the IT environment. From these trends, and any other information from the current version of the course of action, incident service **220** may determine action suggestions to support the request.

[0026] In at least one implementation, incident service may generate a hierarchy of the action suggestions based on the aforementioned factors, wherein suggestions may be promoted or demoted based on the trends from the other courses of action, as well as actions in the current course of action. Once the hierarchy is generated, the suggested actions may be displayed in accordance with the hierarchy, wherein actions may be promoted in a list based on the hierarchy, presented in a different font or font size, highlighted, or presented in some other similar manner to display suggestions in accordance with the hierarchy.

[0027] After causing the display of the action suggestions, operation **300** obtains **(305)** a selection of at least one action and causes **(306)** for display a second version of the course of action, wherein the second version includes the newly selected action. Referring to the example in FIGS. **1A** and **1B**, an analyst may provide input selecting an action from suggested actions **130-135**. In response to the selection, the incident service may update course of action **100** such that it includes the new action coupled to geolocate IP action **122**. As demonstrated in FIG. **1B**, the second version of the course of action includes action **124**, wherein action **124** corresponds to the selection of the analyst. Once an action is added to the course of action, it should be understood that the processes of operation **300** may be repeated as necessary to complete a course of action.

[0028] FIG. **4** illustrates a timing diagram **400** for determining and maintaining course of action trends according to an implementation. Timing diagram **400** includes systems and elements of IT environment **200** of FIG. **2**.

[0029] In operation incident service **220** may obtain courses of action from analyst systems **210-214**, wherein the courses of action each include one or more actions to respond to various incidents in network **230**. In defining each course of action, an analyst may generate a flow diagram providing sequencing information for the various actions associated with the particular course of action, and may further indicate the types of incidents that are related to the particular course of actions. Accordingly, while a first course of action may be generated to respond to an incident of a first incident type, a second course of action may be generated to respond to an incident of a second incident type. The courses of action generated by analysts of IT environment **200** may be generated in response to an incident being identified in at least one component of network **230** or may be generated in anticipation of an incident.

[0030] Once the courses of action are identified from the analyst systems, incident service **220** further determines course of action trends based on the actions implemented in the courses of action. These trends may be based on the frequency that actions are coupled or placed in a particular order, based on the overall actions included in the courses of action, or based on any other similar information derived from the courses of action.

[0031] As the trend information is maintained by incident service **220**, an analyst via analyst system **214** may initiate a request for a new course of action. This request for a new course of action may occur in response to an incident being identified in network **230** or may be initiated

preemptively for an incident in network **230**. Once the request is identified, incident service **220** may cause display of an interface capable of defining a flow diagram of actions to provide the desired course of action.

[0032] In at least one implementation, incident service **220** may cause of display at analyst system **214** a first version of a course of action, wherein the first version may include one or more actions. These actions may include actions to identify supplemental information about an incident (geolocation, file reputation, domain reputation, and the like), may comprise decision actions, may comprise actions to start or stop the course of action, may comprise actions to provide modifications to one or more components of the IT environment, or may comprise any other similar operation. After providing the first version of the course of action, incident service **220** may identify an action request to add a new action to the course of action. This request may be generated by selecting a currently implemented action for which to link to a new action, may be generated by selecting an icon or button to trigger the addition of a new action, or may be generated in any other similar manner. In response to the request, incident service **220** may determine and cause display of action suggestions to support the request, wherein the action suggestion may be determined at least in part on the course of action trends determined from previously generated courses of actions in the IT environment. In some implementations, in addition to the trends, incident service may further determine action suggestions based on the other actions that are implemented in the first course of action, trends from other IT environments (such as other organizations or entities), or from any other similar source.

[0033] In some examples, incident service **220** may determine suggested actions based on comparing available actions to criteria. For example, various actions may be allocated a score based on the relevance of the action in relation to the incident type for the course of action, the relevance of the action in relation to other actions implemented in the course of action, the trends of actions from the previously generated courses of actions, or some other similar factor. Once the scores are determined, actions that meet or satisfy a criteria score may be provided as the suggested actions. In some implementations, in providing the action suggestions, incident service **220** may generate a hierarchy for various actions, wherein the hierarchy may be determined based on similar factors to those described above including, the trends in the actions, the current actions in the course of action, or some other similar factor. Once the hierarchy is generated, the hierarchy may be provided as a list, may promote actions over other actions using font style, size, or highlighting, or may promote actions in some other similar manner.

[0034] Returning to the elements of FIG. 2, analyst systems **210-214**, incident service **220**, and response database **250** may each comprise communication interfaces, network interfaces, processing systems, computer systems, microprocessors, storage systems, storage media, or some other processing devices or software systems, and can be distributed among multiple devices. Examples of analyst systems analyst systems **210-214**, incident service **220**, and response database **250** can include software such as an operating system, logs, databases, utilities, drivers, networking software, and other software stored on a computer-readable medium. Analyst systems analyst systems **210-214**, incident service **220**, and response database **250** may comprise, in some examples, one or more server computing systems, desktop computing systems, laptop computing systems, or any other computing system, including combinations thereof.

[0035] Network **230** includes computing components **240-243**, which may include physical computing systems (host computing systems, user devices, and the like), virtual computing systems, such as virtual machines and containers, routers, switches, and other similar computing systems.

[0036] Communication between analyst systems **210-214**, incident service **220**, response database **250**, and components within network **130** may use metal, glass, optical, air, space, or some other material as the transport media. Communication between analyst systems **210-214**, incident service **220**, response database **250**, and components within network **130** may use various communication

protocols, such as Time Division Multiplex (TDM), asynchronous transfer mode (ATM), Internet Protocol (IP), Ethernet, synchronous optical networking (SONET), hybrid fiber-coax (HFC), circuit-switched, communication signaling, wireless communications, or some other communication format, including combinations, improvements, or variations thereof.

Communication between analyst systems **210-214**, incident service **220**, response database **250**, and components within network **130** may use direct links or can include intermediate networks, systems, or devices, and can include a logical network link transported over multiple physical links. [0037] FIG. 5 illustrates an operational scenario **500** of providing suggested actions according to an implementation. Operational scenario **500** includes incident service **510**, action request **515**, suggested actions **517**, courses of action database **520**, and current course of action information **522**.

[0038] In operational scenario **500**, incident service **510** obtains and identifies, at step **1**, action request **515** from analyst system **530** to add a new action to a course of action, the course capable of responding to incident in an IT environment. In response to the request, incident service **510** determines, at step **2**, supplemental information related to the request that can be used in determining suggested actions to support the request. The supplemental information may include information from courses of action database **520** and/or current course of action information **522**. In particular, courses of action database **520** may include information about other course of action that have been implemented in the same or different IT environments, wherein the information may indicate information about trends in action sequencing from other courses of action, quantities that particular actions have been implemented, frequently used actions or sequences of actions used against particular incident types, or some other similar information. In addition to, or in place of the information from other courses of action database **520**, incident service **510** may use current course of action information **522** related to the current course of action. In some implementations, current course of action information **522** may provide information about preceding or subsequent actions to the requested action, information about the type of incident for the course of action, information about the various actions in the course of action, or some other similar information.

[0039] Once the supplemental information is identified for the request, incident service **510** may determine, at step **3**, suggested actions **517** to be provided to the analyst based on the supplemental information. Additionally, the supplemental information may be used to prioritize or otherwise indicate a hierarchy of the action suggestions, such that an action that is identified as most relevant may be promoted over other suggestions in suggested actions **517**. Once suggested actions **517** are generated and displayed at analyst system **530**, the analyst may select the desired action to be added to the course of action.

[0040] FIGS. **6A-6B** illustrate an interface for defining a course of action according to an implementation. FIGS. **6A-6B** include course of action **600** with start action **621**, geolocate IP action **622**, file reputation action **623**, and end action **627**. FIG. **6A** further includes suggested actions **640** with actions **630-635** coupled to geolocate IP action **622** through link **604**, and suggested options **660** with options **650-653**. FIG. **6B** further includes selected action **630** with option **653**.

[0041] Referring to FIG. **6A**, an incident service may cause display of an interface that provides a platform for analysts to generate courses of actions to respond to various incidents. Here, a first version of course of action **600** is provided wherein start action **621** continues to geolocate IP action **622** and file reputation action **623**. Once file reputation action **623** completes, the course of action continues to end action **627**, while the path associated with the geolocate IP action **622** remains incomplete. In the present implementation, a request is generated to add a new action subsequent to geolocate IP **622**. In response to the request, the incident service determines suggested actions **640** as described herein and further determines suggested options **660**, wherein the options may comprise different services (such as external databases and websites) to support the action, different versions of a particular action, or some other similar type of option. For

example, an action to determine a reputation of an IP address may be capable of using a variety of services, which can provide the information in the same or different formats. As a result, various options may be provided to the analyst indicating the various options for the action. In some implementations, the options may be determined based on components and/or services that are available to the analyst or the IT environment. For instance, a first analyst may be allocated permission to implement particular options, while a second analyst for the same IT environment may be allocated permission to implement different options. Similarly, an IT environment may only subscribe to a subset of available services resulting in the IT environment being allocated one set of options, while a different IT environment may be provided with a different set of options.

Additionally, similar to how the action suggestions may be prioritized or placed in a hierarchy, options may be promoted or placed in a hierarchy based on actions in the current course of action (e.g. actions that require a particular data format), or based on trends from other courses of action. [0042] Turning to FIG. 6B, because an analyst selected action **630** with option **653**, the incident service may add the corresponding action to the current course of action **600**, resulting in an updated version of the course of action that can be displayed for the analyst. Once added, additional actions may be added to the course of action by the analyst to provide the desired operations.

[0043] In some implementations, each action in course of action **600** corresponds to instructions in one or more programming languages, scripts, or other similar languages capable of providing the required functions for the actions. These languages may be capable of interacting with components with different hardware and software configurations, services with different format requirements, or some other communication and configuration requirement.

[0044] FIG. 7 illustrates an interface indicative of frequently used paths in a course of action according to an implementation. The interface of FIG. 7 includes course of action **700**, wherein course of action **700** further includes actions for start action **721**, geolocate IP action **722**, decision action **724**, block IP action **725**, create ticket action **726**, and end action **727**. Decision action **724** further includes operation **701** to determine the source of an action and create ticket action **726** further includes operation **702** to allocate incidents to particular analysts.

[0045] As described herein, an incident service may be used as a platform to generate and implement courses of actions to various incidents within an IT environment. Once a course of action is generated, analysts within the environment may desire to monitor how incidents are processed by each of the courses of action. In particular, analysts may desire to monitor the quantity of incidents that are responded to using the course of action, the various paths that are used in each course of action, the quantity or frequency that each of the paths are used, or some other information about the course of action. In the example of course of action **700**, an incident service may generate an interface that demonstrates a frequency or “heat map” that the actions in course of action **700** are used when the course of action is deployed. In one implementation, the incident service may monitor incident responses implemented in the IT environment. In monitoring the incident responses, the incident service may determine which courses of action are implemented, the path or paths that are used within the courses of action for each of the incident responses, or some other similar information about the incident responses.

[0046] As the information is monitored, an analyst may request the incident service, or the incident service may provide as part of a notification, an interface that demonstrates information about course of action **700**. For example, an analyst may desire information about course of action **700** prior to implementing an incident response using course of action **700**. In response to the request, the incident service may cause display of course of action **700** with indications for the frequency that each of the actions are used in responding to previous incidents. Here, the most frequently used path includes geolocate IP action **722**, decision action **724**, block IP action **725**, and end action **727**, while create ticket action **726** is used less frequently. The display of course of action **700** may include shading, colors, numerical values, or some other similar information to indicate the frequency that each of the actions are used as part of the course of action. This information may

permit analysts to identify actions that are not being used as desired, trends in the incident identified in the environment, or some other similar information for the course of action. Further, in some example, the information provided in the interface may provide suggestions for decision operations based on the frequency that actions are executed. Accordingly, if an action in the plurality of actions were not being used, the suggestions may identify a value that would increase the use of the action and provide the value in the interface.

[0047] In at least one implementation, an operation for the incident service may monitor implementations of course of action **700** in the IT environment, wherein the monitoring may determine the frequency or quantity that each of the actions are used when the course of action is deployed. As the information is maintained, the incident service may identify a request to generate a display of the course of action. In response to the request, the incident service may generate a flow diagram, such as that depicted in FIG. 7, that indicates a frequency or quantity that each of the actions were implemented as part of the course of action.

[0048] FIG. 8 illustrates an incident service computing system according to an implementation. Computing system **800** is representative of any computing system or systems with which the various operational architectures, processes, scenarios, and sequences disclosed herein for an incident service may be implemented. Computing system **800** is an example of incident service **220**, although other examples may exist. Computing system **800** comprises communication interface **801**, user interface **802**, and processing system **803**. Processing system **803** is linked to communication interface **801** and user interface **802**. Processing system **803** includes processing circuitry **805** and memory device **806** that stores operating software **807**. Computing system **800** may include other well-known components such as a battery and enclosure that are not shown for clarity.

[0049] Communication interface **801** comprises components that communicate over communication links, such as network cards, ports, radio frequency (RF), processing circuitry and software, or some other communication devices. Communication interface **801** may be configured to communicate over metallic, wireless, or optical links. Communication interface **801** may be configured to use Time Division Multiplex (TDM), Internet Protocol (IP), Ethernet, optical networking, wireless protocols, communication signaling, or some other communication format-including combinations thereof. In at least one implementation, communication interface **801** may be used to communicate analyst consoles or systems as well as computing components within an IT environment. In some implementations communication interface **801** may further communicate with databases or other services that maintain information about courses of action for the IT environment.

[0050] User interface **802** comprises components that interact with a user to receive user inputs and to present media and/or information. User interface **802** may include a speaker, microphone, buttons, lights, display screen, touch screen, touch pad, scroll wheel, communication port, or some other user input/output apparatus-including combinations thereof. User interface **802** may be omitted in some examples.

[0051] Processing circuitry **805** comprises microprocessor and other circuitry that retrieves and executes operating software **807** from memory device **806**. Memory device **806** may include volatile and nonvolatile, removable and non-removable media implemented in any method or technology for storage of information, such as computer readable instructions, data structures, program modules, or other data. Memory device **806** may be implemented as a single storage device, but may also be implemented across multiple storage devices or sub-systems. Memory device **806** may comprise additional elements, such as a controller to read operating software **807**. Examples of storage media include random access memory, read only memory, magnetic disks, optical disks, and flash memory, as well as any combination or variation thereof, or any other type of storage media. In some implementations, the storage media may be a non-transitory storage media. In some instances, at least a portion of the storage media may be transitory. It should be

understood that in no case is the storage media a propagated signal.

[0052] Processing circuitry **805** is typically mounted on a circuit board that may also hold memory device **806** and portions of communication interface **801** and user interface **802**. Operating software **807** comprises computer programs, firmware, or some other form of machine-readable program instructions. Operating software **807** includes display module **808**, request module **809**, and suggestion module **810**, although any number of software modules may provide a similar operation. Operating software **807** may further include an operating system, utilities, drivers, network interfaces, applications, or some other type of software. When executed by processing circuitry **805**, operating software **807** directs processing system **803** to operate computing system **800** as described herein.

[0053] In one implementation, display module **808** directs processing system **803** to cause for display a first version of a course of action. Once displayed, request module **809** may identify a request to add an action to the course of action. In response to the request, suggestion module **810** may direct processing system **803** to determine action suggestions based on the request and cause display of the suggestions for an analyst that generated the request. The suggestions may be based on the precedent or subsequent action to the new action, may be based on the other actions in the course of action, may be based on trends from other courses of action, or may be based on any other similar action information. Once displayed, request module **809** may identify a request for an action from the suggested actions, and display module **808** may cause display of a second version of the course of action that includes the desired action.

[0054] As an example, a first version of a course of action may comprise an action to identify the geolocation of an IP address associated with the incident (e.g. the source of the communication generating the incident). Accordingly, the action suggestions provided by computing system **800** may include suggestions for providing operations to process the geolocation, such as processing the communication in a first manner when the geolocation corresponds to a first location, as opposed to when the geolocation corresponds to a second location. Once the suggestions are identified, the suggestions may be provided to the requesting analyst, wherein the analyst may select a suggestion causing the new action to be added as part of a second version of the course of action.

[0055] The included descriptions and figures depict specific implementations to teach those skilled in the art how to make and use the best mode. For the purpose of teaching inventive principles, some conventional aspects have been simplified or omitted. Those skilled in the art will appreciate variations from these implementations that fall within the scope of the invention. Those skilled in the art will also appreciate that the features described above can be combined in various ways to form multiple implementations. As a result, the invention is not limited to the specific implementations described above, but only by the claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A method, comprising: causing, by an incident service, display of a first version of a course of action, the first version of the course of action comprising one or more actions for responding to an occurrence of an incident in an information technology (IT) environment; receiving, by the incident service, input identifying a suggested action for inclusion in the first version of the course of action, the suggested action identified based at least in part on one or more attributes associated with the incident; causing, by the incident service, display of a second version of the course of action, the second version of the course of action comprising the one or more actions and the suggested action, and the second version of the course of action identifying a sequence for executing the one or more actions and the suggested action; and causing, by the incident service, the second version of the course of action to be executed, wherein the causing comprises executing the one or more actions and the suggested action according to the identified sequence.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the suggested action is a first suggested action, wherein the IT

- environment includes a plurality of types of services and wherein the method further comprises: determining a second suggested action based at least in part on a type of service from the plurality of types of services; and causing display of a ranked set of suggested actions, wherein the ranked set of suggested actions prioritizes the first suggested action over the second suggested action.
- 3.** The method of claim 1, wherein the suggested action is a first suggested action, wherein the IT environment further includes a plurality of types of computing devices, and wherein the method further comprises: determining a second suggested action based at least in part on a type of computing device from the plurality of types of computing device; and causing display of a ranked set of suggested actions, wherein the ranked set of suggested actions prioritizes the first suggested action over the second suggested action.
- 4.** The method of claim 1, wherein the one or more attributes associated with the incident comprises at least one of a domain name or an Internet Protocol (IP) address.
- 5.** The method of claim 1, wherein the one or more actions and the suggested action are represented in a visual representation in the second version of the course of action using one or more blocks, wherein the one or more blocks includes at least a first action block corresponding to the suggested action.
- 6.** The method of claim 1, wherein execution of the suggested action involves using a format of a score or value returned as part of a preexisting action of the course of action.
- 7.** The method of claim 1, further comprising: identifying one or more trends in action sequences associated with other courses of action; and wherein the suggested action is further determined based on the identified one or more trends.
- 8.** A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium storing instructions which, when executed by one or more processors, cause performance of operations comprising: causing, by an incident service, display of a first version of the course of action, the first course of action comprising the one or more actions for responding to an occurrence of an incident in an information technology (IT) environment; receiving, by the incident service, input identifying a suggested action for inclusion in the first version of the course of action, the suggested action identified based at least in part on one or more attributes associated with the incident; causing, by the incident service, display of a second version of the course of action, the second version of the course of action comprising the one or more actions and the suggested action, and the second version of the course of action identifying a sequence for executing the one or more actions and the suggested action; and causing, by the incident service, the second version of the course of action to be executed, wherein the causing comprises executing the one or more actions and the suggested action according to the identified sequence.
- 9.** The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the suggested action is a first suggested action, wherein the IT environment includes a plurality of types of services and wherein the instructions, when executed by the one or more processors, further cause performance of operations comprising: determining a second suggested action based at least in part on a type of service from the plurality of types of services; and causing display of a ranked set of suggested actions, wherein the ranked set of suggested actions prioritizes the first suggested action over the second suggested action.
- 10.** The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the suggested action is a first suggested action, wherein the IT environment further includes a plurality of types of computing devices, and wherein the instructions, when executed by the one or more processors, further cause performance of operations comprising: determining a second suggested action based at least in part on a type of computing device from the plurality of types of computing device; and causing display of a ranked set of suggested actions, wherein the ranked set of suggested actions prioritizes the first suggested action over the second suggested action.
- 11.** The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the one or more attributes associated with the incident comprises at least one of a domain name or an Internet

Protocol (IP) address.

12. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the one or more actions and the suggested action are represented in a visual representation in the second version of the course of action using one or more blocks, wherein the one or more blocks includes at least a first action block corresponding to the suggested action.

13. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein execution of the suggested action involves using a format of a score or value returned as part of a preexisting action of the course of action.

14. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the instructions, when executed by the one or more processors, further cause performance of operations comprising: identifying one or more trends in action sequences associated with other courses of action; and wherein the suggested action is further determined based on the identified one or more trends.

15. An apparatus, comprising: one or more processors; a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium storing instructions which, when executed by the one or more processors, cause the apparatus to: cause, by an incident service, display of a first version of the course of action, the first version of the course of action comprising the one or more actions for responding to an occurrence of an incident in an information technology (IT) environment; receive, by the incident service, input identifying a suggested action for inclusion in the first version of the course of action, the suggested action identified based at least in part on one or more attributes associated with the incident; cause, by the incident service, display of a second version of the course of action, the second version of the course of action comprising the one or more actions and the suggested action, and the second version of the course of action identifying a sequence for executing the one or more actions and the suggested action; and cause, by the incident service, the second version of the course of action to be executed, wherein the causing comprises executing the one or more actions and the suggested action according to the identified sequence.

16. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the suggested action is a first suggested action, wherein the IT environment includes a plurality of types of services, and wherein the instructions further direct the apparatus to: determine a second suggested action based at least in part on a type of service from the plurality of types of services; and cause display of a ranked set of suggested actions, wherein the ranked set of suggested actions prioritizes the first suggested action over the second suggested action.

17. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the suggested action is a first suggested action, wherein the IT environment further includes a plurality of types of computing devices, and wherein the instructions further direct the apparatus to: determine a second suggested action based at least in part on a type of computing device from the plurality of types of computing device; and cause display of a ranked set of suggested actions, wherein the ranked set of suggested actions prioritizes the first suggested action over the second suggested action.

18. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the one or more attributes associated with the incident comprises at least one of a domain name or an Internet Protocol (IP) address.

19. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein the one or more actions and the suggested action are represented in a visual representation in the second version of the course of action using one or more blocks, wherein the one or more blocks includes at least a first action block corresponding to the suggested action.

20. The apparatus of claim 15, wherein execution of the suggested action involves using a format of a score or value returned as part of a preexisting action of the course of action.
